

BRAND STYLE GUIDE · 2026

UniTrade

Brand Overview

The single source of truth for how UniTrade looks, speaks, and feels — across web, mobile, and print.

Version	Platform	Context
1.0	Web & Mobile	South African Universities

SECTION 1

Colour Palette

Every colour in UniTrade's system has a specific role. Using colours outside this palette — or in the wrong proportion — breaks brand consistency and reduces trust.

#0D1F4E

Primary Blue
RGB (27, 117, 188)
Headers, primary buttons, key accents, active nav states

#04B4FD

Secondary Blue
RGB (0, 174, 239)
Borders, inactive states, dividers, badges, chat timestamps

#0D1F4E

Accent Dark Blue
RGB (38, 34, 98)
Footer backgrounds, hover states, emphasised text

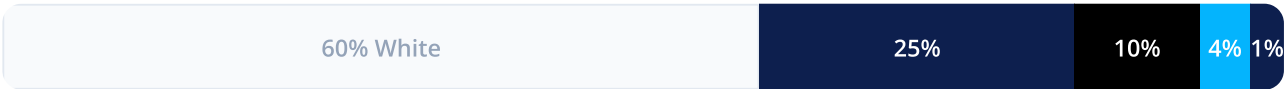
#ffffff

Neutral White
RGB (255, 255, 255)
Backgrounds, cards, text on dark colours, form fields

#000000

Neutral Black
RGB (0, 0, 0)
Body text, headings, input borders, dark UI elements

COLOUR USAGE RATIOS — PER SCREEN



- White (~60%) — backgrounds, cards, forms

Primary Blue (~25%) — header, buttons, nav
- Black (~10%) — body text, borders

Secondary Blue (~4%) — badges, dividers
- Dark Accent (~1%) — footer, hover

INTERACTIVE STATES

Element	Default	Hover / Active
Primary Button	#0D1F4E	#0D1F4E
Secondary Button	White + #0D1F4E border	Fill #04B4FD, white text
Links	#0D1F4E	Underlined

COLOUR DO'S & DON'TS

✓ Do

Use #0D1F4E as the primary button and header colour

Use white backgrounds with blue accents for cards

Use #0D1F4E only for footer and hover states

Use #04B4FD for dividers, badges, and secondary elements

Maintain the 60/25/10/4/1 ratio per screen

✗ Don't

Don't use colours outside this palette (e.g. random greens or reds for branding)

Don't place dark blue (#0D1F4E) as a main background for entire pages

Don't use low-contrast combos like light blue text on white

Don't overuse the accent dark blue — it is meant to be rare

Don't use colour alone to convey status — always pair with text or icons

SECTION 2

Typography

UniTrade uses **Poppins** for headings (strong, geometric, trustworthy) and **Open Sans** for body text (readable, warm, accessible). Both are free for web use.

ELEMENT	FONT & WEIGHT	SIZE	LINE HEIGHT	COLOUR	LIVE SAMPLE
H1 — Page Title	Poppins Bold 700	40px / 2.5rem	1.2	#000000	Browse Listings
H2 — Section Heading	Poppins Semi-Bold 600	32px / 2rem	1.3	#000000	What We Offer
H3 — Card Title	Poppins Semi-Bold 600	24px / 1.5rem	1.4	#0D1F4E	Biology Textbook
Subheading	Poppins Medium 500	20px / 1.25rem	1.4	#04B4FD	University of Pretoria
Body Text (Large)	Open Sans Regular 400	18px / 1.125rem	1.5	#000000	Good condition, minor highlighting on pages 3–5.
Body Text (Standard)	Open Sans Regular 400	16px / 1rem	1.5	#000000	Reserve now to hold this item for 24 hours.
Small / Meta	Open Sans Regular 400	14px / 0.875rem	1.4	Black 60%	BIO121 · Listed 7 May 2026 · 42 views

ELEMENT	FONT & WEIGHT	SIZE	LINE HEIGHT	COLOUR	LIVE SAMPLE
Button / Label	Poppins Medium 500	16px / 1rem	1.2	White on dark	Reserve

✓ Do

Use Poppins for all headings (H1–H3) and button labels

Use Open Sans for body copy, descriptions, and meta text

Keep H1 at 40px — do not make page titles smaller

Use #0D1F4E for H3 card titles to create visual hierarchy

Keep body text at minimum 16px for accessibility

✗ Don't

Don't use more than 2 font families on any page

Don't use font weights lighter than 400 (Regular)

Don't set body text below 14px — it becomes unreadable

Don't use ALL CAPS for body text (only acceptable in small labels)

Don't mix Poppins and Open Sans in the same sentence

SECTION 3

UI Components

All interactive elements follow a consistent visual pattern. Below are the live components with their correct colours, states, and usage rules.

BUTTONS

Reserve Item

Add to Wishlist

Report listing

Type	Background	Text
Primary	#0D1F4E → hover #0D1F4E	White
Secondary	White → hover #04B4FD	#0D1F4E
Report Link	Transparent	#0D1F4E, underline hover

STATUS BADGES

Live

Needs Review

Rejected

Good Condition

2 Interested

Badge	Background	Text
Live	#B3E4C0 (green-100)	#1a6b2e
Needs Review	#FFE798 (yellow-100)	#7a5800
Rejected	#FFADAD (red-100)	#8b0000

LISTING CARD

IMG

Biology Textbook
BIO121 · UP
R1 200

Reserve

Add to Wishlist

Card border: 1px solid #04B4FD · Background: white

FORM INPUTS

COURSE CODE

BIO121

PRICE (ZAR)

R 1 200

Border: 1px solid #04B4FD · Focus ring: #0D1F4E at 12% opacity

CHAT BUBBLES

Hi, is this textbook still available?

Yes it is! Can meet tomorrow at Library Cafe.

Perfect, see you at 2pm!

Bubble	Background	Text
Buyer (received)	White + subtle shadow	#000000
Seller (sent)	#0D1F4E	White

COMPONENT RULES

- Do:** Always pair Reserve (primary) + Add to Wishlist (secondary) on listing cards
- Do:** Use pill-shaped badges (border-radius: 20px) for all status labels
- Don't:** Use red as a button colour — red is only for destructive badge states
- Don't:** Create new button styles — use only Primary, Secondary, or Link

SECTION 4

Logo Usage

The UniTrade logo must always have clear space around it and may only appear in approved colour versions.

Context	Minimum Width	Notes
Desktop / Tablet website	120px	Wordmark + icon mark
Mobile website / app header	90px	Icon + abbreviated wordmark if needed
Print (business cards, flyers)	25mm (~1 inch)	Use vector format only
Favicon / App icon	32 × 32px	Icon only — no wordmark

✓ Do

- Use the logo exactly as provided — no modifications
- Always maintain clear space (no text or graphics crowding the logo)
- Use the reversed white version on dark backgrounds
- Scale the logo proportionally when resizing
- Use the icon alone as a favicon or app badge

✗ Don't

- Don't stretch or distort the logo disproportionately
- Don't change logo colours except to approved mono versions (white or black)
- Don't place the logo on busy photography without a solid backing or scrim
- Don't rotate or tilt the logo
- Don't add drop shadows, glows, or outlines to the logo

SECTION 5

Tone of Voice

UniTrade speaks like a trustworthy peer — not a corporation. Short sentences, active voice, honest language. Here are real examples of what that sounds like.

WRITE LIKE THIS

"We verify, you trade safely."

NOT LIKE THIS

"We are not responsible for transactions conducted on this platform."

WRITE LIKE THIS

"Check in when you arrive."

NOT LIKE THIS

"Location verification shall be performed upon arrival at the designated meetup point."

WRITE LIKE THIS

"No payment until you meet and inspect in person."

NOT LIKE THIS

"Payment processing will be withheld until physical inspection has occurred."

WRITE LIKE THIS

"Your listing was rejected. Here's why and how to fix it."

NOT LIKE THIS

"Your submission did not meet the required criteria and has been declined."

Three Core Principles

Trustworthy, not cold

We protect users without hiding behind legalese.

Student-first, not academic

Short sentences. Active voice. Real language.

Direct about rules

No fine print. No hidden catches.

SECTION 6

Imagery & Photography

Photography choices reflect the real South African student experience — not polished stock imagery.

✓ Use

Real students on South African campuses (UP, Wits, UCT, etc.)

Study sessions, meetups at libraries and cafes

Textbook close-ups and phone showing the app

Warm, natural lighting with no heavy filters

Overlays over hero images to ensure text contrast

✗ Avoid

Generic "businesspeople" stock photos

Foreign campuses that don't reflect SA student life

Heavy Instagram-style filters or colour grading

Posed, unnatural looking studio photos

Images that don't relate to academic or student life

UniTrade — Brand Style Guide v1.0
COS301 Capstone Project · University of
Pretoria · 2026

For questions, contact the frontend team.
This document is the single source of truth for brand
decisions.